

Rough



Yellow-green rough | Yellow-green is the most common tourmaline colour, although the above piece of facet rough is slightly more yellow than most.



Indicolite rough | Blue is a less common colour for tourmaline and is called indicolite. It can vary from light to deep blue in hue. This piece of rough has particularly good colour.

Concentric colour-zoning



Colour zoning | Tourmaline can have concentric colour-zoning. When the centre is pink and the outer is green, as here, it is called watermelon tourmaline.

Varieties



Achroite | Achroite is the colour-name given to colourless tourmaline, seen here shaped as a 12.24-carat, rectangular, brilliant-cut cushion.



Indicolite tourmaline | Blue tourmaline is called indicolite. This flawless 7.79-carat indicolite gem is faceted as a hexagonal mixed cut.



Paraiba tourmaline | Paraiba tourmaline is relatively new to the gem market. It contains copper and has a "neon" look. A green example is shown here.



Dravite tourmaline | Dravite is brown tourmaline, and is not common in facet-grade material. This cushion mixed-cut dravite is particularly fine.



Rubellite tourmaline | Red or pink-red tourmaline is called rubellite. Shades range from pale pink to shocking red. This emerald step-cut rubellite shows classic colour.

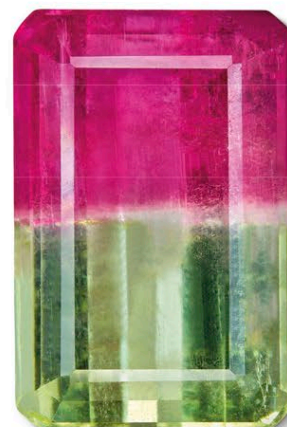


Yellow-green tourmaline | Strangely, there is no colour-name for yellow-green tourmaline, although this example, shaped in a trillion cut, is a fine gem.

Natural flaws on face of gem



Yellow-green tourmaline | With its colour tending more towards green than yellow, this 4.20-carat, brilliant-cut gem has a few natural flaws.



Watermelon tourmaline | Occasionally a piece of watermelon tourmaline, such as this emerald-cut stone, is wide enough for a gem to be faceted across the colour zoning.



Schorl tourmaline | Schorl is black tourmaline and always opaque. Of all the tourmalines, it is the most common. It is shown here as tumble polished.